

Alex Bruens, Ph.D.

CONTACT INFORMATION	University of Nebraska at Omaha National Counterterrorism Innovation, Technology, and Education Center (NCITE)	<i>email:</i> abruens@nebraska.edu <i>web:</i> www.abruens.com
RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE	Assistant Research Professor Present National Counterterrorism Innovation, Technology, and Education Center (NCITE) at the University of Nebraska at Omaha Collaborate on research for U.S. government contract. Lead IRB and compliance for the center. Develop requests for information and requests for assistance from U.S. government. Assist with strategy development and writing. Co-lead and participate in research projects on terrorism and counterterrorism. <i>As Research Fellow and Research Associate (June 2024-December 2025)</i> Contribute to scientific review for federally funded projects. Lead IRB and compliance process. Assist with annual reporting, project management, and grant/proposal writing. Co-established a research lab led by Dr. Gina Ligon. Research Manager August 2021 - August 2024 Research on International Policy Implementation Lab (RIPIL) at American University <i>Project Title:</i> "Networks of Influence and Support in Peace Operations" Graduate Research Assistant August 2021 - May 2023 University of Arizona	
EDUCATION	Ph.D. Government and Public Policy, University of Arizona 2024 Major in International Relations, Minor in Quantitative Research Methodology <i>Dissertation:</i> "Repression in Conflict-Affected States: The Role of United Nations Peace Operations" <i>Committee:</i> Jessica Maves Braithwaite (Chair), Daniel Arnon, Susanna Campbell (<i>American University</i>), Kirssa Ryckman M.A. Government and Public Policy, University of Arizona 2021 B.A. Political Science, Arabic Minor, Florida Atlantic University 2019 <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> with Honors B.A. Sociology, Florida Atlantic University 2019	
PUBLIC & POLICY ENGAGEMENT	5. "NCITE Response to Request for Information: Nebraska Unicameral Technology Committee." Elson, J. S., Bruens, A., Doctor, A., Hunter, S., Allen, M., Ligon, G. S. 2025. <i>A technical report from the National Counterterrorism, Innovation, Technology, and Education (NCITE) Center based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number, 20STTPC00001-05.</i> 4. Congressional testimony for "Match Ready: Oversight of the Federal Government's Border Management and Personal Readiness Efforts for the Decade of Sports" and responses to questions for the record delivered by Dr. Gina Ligon (<i>research support</i>). 3. "Designating Cartels and Other Organizations as Foreign Terrorist Organizations and Specially Designated Global Terrorists." Bruens, A., Harms, M. 2025. <i>A technical report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05.</i> 2. "Protecting American Communities from Emerging Terrorist Threats: A Guide for the Next Administration's First Year in Office." Allen, M., Bruens, A., Crenshaw, M., Doctor,	

A., Elson, J., Hughes, S., Hunter, S., Kearns, E., Ligon, G., Rottweiler, B., Wein, M. 2024. *A report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05.*

1. "NCITE Rapid-Response Report: Migration and Terrorism Nexus." **Bruens, A.**, Ward, E., Doctor, A., Hughes, S., Ligon, G.S. 2024. *A technical report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05.*

ACADEMIC PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

4. "Do Union Rights Matter for Civil Resistance? Limited Evidence from Cross-National Data"
3. "Deadly Persuasion: How Leaders Influence Lethality and Sustainability in Violent Extremist Organizations" with Mackenzie Harms and Gina Ligon
2. "Resumes for Resolution: Rebel Leader Pre-War Job Experience and Civil War Negotiations" with Mackenzie Harms and Gina Ligon
1. "The Networks that Built the Camps: How Government Use of Concentration Camps Diffuses Globally" with Rachel Van Nostrand and Alex Braithwaite

WORKING ACADEMIC PAPERS

7. "Human Rights in the New Era of United Nations Peace Operations: Interventions and violent state repression" (dissertation chapter)
6. "A Shock to Whose System? The Effects of USAID's Withdrawal on the Global Aid Ecosystem" with Jessica Maves Braithwaite, Susanna Campbell, Nuole Chen, Cecilia Caverio-Sánchez, Shahryar Minhas, Jared Edgerton, and Madeline Fleishman.
5. "Who Keeps the Peace? Reconceptualizing Aid Actors through Networks of Influence and Support" with Jessica Maves Braithwaite, Susanna Campbell, and Hatem Zayed
4. "Determinants of United Nations Peace Operations" (dissertation chapter)
3. "UN Peace Operations and Nonviolent State Repression" (dissertation chapter)
2. "Peace Accords and Post-war Civil Society"
1. "Civil Society Repression in Post-Civil War States"

ACADEMIC WORKS IN PROGRESS

3. "Blueprints for Peace: Optimizing UN Missions' Mandates" with Cameron Mailhot.
2. "Writing for Rights: Non-governmental organization agenda setting at the United Nations Human Rights Council" with Chaelin Kwon and Alianna Casas.
1. "Networks of Cooperation and Contestation in Conflict" with Jessica Maves Braithwaite and Susanna Campbell.

NON-REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

2. "Book Review: Fentanyl: Fighting the Mass Poisoning of America and the Cartel Behind It by Jake Braun." **Bruens, Alex.** Forthcoming. *Journal of Policing, Intelligence, and Counterterrorism.*
1. "Redefining Post-Conflict Peacekeeping Success in Regional and International Missions." **Bruens, Alexander,** and Mirella Miranda. 2018. *Florida Political Chronicle*, 26(1): 68—82.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i>	Spring 2026
POL 419: Terrorism and Counterterrorism	
Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i>	Spring & Summer 2024
POL 202: International Relations	
Instructor <i>University of Arizona</i>	Fall 2023
POL 415: The Scientific Study of Civil Wars	
Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i>	Summer 2022
POL 202: International Relations	

	Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>University of Arizona</i> POL 202: International Relations	2019–2021
CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION	Peace Science Society Annual Conference Political Economy of International Organization Annual Meeting International Studies Association Annual Meeting Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2022, 2023 2023 2023 2019
INVITED WORKSHOPS	Peace Science Society. <i>New Research about Preventing Mass Atrocities</i> International Studies Association. <i>Bringing Firms into Global Local Networks of Conflict Prevention and Peacebuilding</i> Bridging the Gap. <i>New Era Workshop</i> (Denver, CO)	November 2023 March 2023 October 2022
GRANTS, AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	University of Arizona Graduate and Professional Student Association Microgrant, \$250. International Studies Scholarship Private donor, \$750. Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR) attendance grant, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$3,080. Michael P. Sullivan Graduate Research Award in International Relations, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$750. Charles E., Jr. Starns Fellowship, School of Government & Public Policy University of Arizona, \$3,500. Dissertation Fellowship, College of Social and Behavioral Sciences, University of Arizona, \$8,000. Love of Learning Award Phi Kappa Phi, \$500. Summer Research Grant, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$6,800 total.	2024 2023 2023 2023 2023 2023 2022 2020, 2021
TRAVEL & CONFERENCE GRANTS	International Studies Association workshop participant grant, \$300 International Studies Association travel grant, \$750 School of Government & Public Policy travel grant, \$300	2023 2023 2023
SERVICE	President Government & Public Policy Graduate Student Association Reviewer Journal of Peace Research Student Organizer Advocates for Youth	2021–2022 2021 2017–2019

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